These are further classified as

a. Insecticides:

Insecticides like DDT, BHC, aldrin etc. can stay in soil for long period of time and are absorbed by soil. They contaminate root crops like carrot, raddish, etc.

b. Fungicide:

Organo mercury compounds are used as most common fungicide. They dissociate in soil to produce mercury which is highly toxic.

c. Herbicides:

Herbicides are the chemical compounds used to control unwanted plants. They are otherwise known as weed killers. Example sodium chlorate ($NaClO_3$) and sodium arsenite (Na_3AsO_3). Most of the herbicides are toxic to mammals.

3) Industrial wastes

Industrial activities have been the biggest contributor to the soil pollution especially the mining and manufacturing activities.

Large number of toxic wastes are released from industries. Industrial wastes include cyanides, chromates, acids, alkalis, and metals like mercury, copper, zinc, cadmium and lead etc. These industrial wastes in the soil surface lie for a long time and make it unsuitable for use.

15.9 Strategies to control environmental pollution

After studying air, water and soil pollution, as responsible individuals we must take responsibility to protect our environment. Think of steps which you would like to undertake for controlling environmental pollution not only in your locality but also in national and international level. We must realize about our environmental threat, focus strongly on this issues and be an eye opener to save our environment. We can think about following strategies to control environmental pollution.

1. Waste management: Environmental pollution can be controlled by proper disposal of wastes.

2. Recycling: a large amount of disposed waste material can be reused by recycling the waste, thus it reduces the land fill and converts waste into useful forms.

3. Substitution of less toxic solvents for highly toxic ones used in certain industrial processes.

4. Use of fuels with lower sulphur content (e.g., washed coal)

5. Growing more trees.

6. Control measures in vehicle emissions are adequate.

Efforts to control environmental pollution have resulted in development of science for synthesis of chemical favorable to environment and it is called green chemistry.

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